

Ashish Pandla

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PROFILE SUMMARY

Results-driven Finance Leader with 8 years of experience across FP&A, financial controlling, and strategic business collaborating at **Cars24** and **Cargo-Partner**. Expertise in budgeting, forecasting, profitability analysis, financial reporting, cost optimization, and compliances. Proven record of driving **profitability improvement, cost efficiency, and stronger financial control**. Trusted partner to senior leadership, translating financial insights into strategic decisions, business growth..

EXPERIENCE

Senior Manager (India Lead) - Controlling/Business Finance

Cargo Partner Logistics India Pvt. Ltd. (Subsidiary of Nippon Express)

Gurugram, Aug 2023 - Present

- **Budgeting & Forecasting:** Led annual budgets and rolling forecasts, tracked performance through variance analysis and delivered actionable insights to leadership.
- **Financial Modelling:** Developed comprehensive financial models and dynamic MIS dashboards (Budget vs. Actual, Sales rankings, and KPI trackers) for data-driven decision-making.
- **Cost Optimization:** Spearheaded strategic cost-control initiatives across cost centers, identified operational leakages, and resulted in savings of ~₹50 lacs annually.
- **Revenue Growth:** Tracked revenue trends at profit center level and identified growth opportunities to drive revenue growth and strengthen revenue assurance.
- **Profitability and Turnaround:** Analyzed critical margins (Gross Margin, Net Margin, and EBITDA), driving a 20% boost in operational productivity and turning ~75% of profit centers profitable.
- **Return on Investment (ROI):** Evaluated sales performance against KPIs and implemented corrective actions to enhance ROI from one time to 2x.
- **Business Partnering:** Collaborated closely with business heads to co-pilot strategic growth, margin improvement, and cross-functional operational efficiency.
- **Working Capital Management:** Optimized receivables, payables, and cash flow to maintain liquidity and efficiency.

Senior Manager/Finance Controller

Cars24 Services Pvt. Ltd.

Gurugram, Dec 2019 to Aug 2023

- **Month-End Closing:** Streamlined monthly and annual book closure, ensuring adherence to relevant accounting Standards and compressing the closing timelines (from 11th to 7th day).
- **Financial Reporting:** Prepared and reviewed financial statements under Ind-AS (including 119, 115, 116, and 102). Managed the entire financial execution for ₹80 Cr ESOP share buyback.
- **Financial Analysis:** Spearheaded cost variance analyses and end-to-end revenue assurance audits to eliminate financial leakage, enforce strict spend control, and safeguard bottom-line margins.
- **Audit & Due Diligence:** Spearheaded statutory, tax, and ICFR audits in coordination with external auditors (EY, GT), successfully resolving critical control deficiencies and high-risk observations to achieve a 100% clean internal audit report.
- **International Expansion:** Spearheaded international expansion by setting up end-to-end financial processes, capital structure, and books of accounts. Managed external consultants and the first statutory audits across all new markets to drive immediate compliance.
- **Team Leadership:** Recruited, managed, and mentored a high-performing 10-member team, driving KPI-led performance and supporting business growth objectives.
- **Process Optimization:** Streamlined P2P and O2C processes, embedding risk controls to eliminate operational redundancies.

Audit Executive

N K Jain & Co.

Gurugram, Jan 2019 to Dec 2019

- **Internal Audit:** Conducted end-to-end internal audits, including physical verification, to evaluate operational and financial controls.
- **Audit Planning & Execution:** Designed audit plans, testing procedures, and reports to ensure robust assessment of financial statements and internal controls.
- **GST Compliance & Filings:** Led preparation and filing of GST returns and audits, ensuring full regulatory compliance.
- **Process Implementation:** Established and streamlined GST compliance processes in line with regulatory requirements.
- **Advisory & Research:** Provided expert guidance on GST laws through detailed research, ensuring accurate and timely client advisory.

EDUCATION

- ✓ Chartered Accountant (CA), ICAI – 2018 (55%, Exemption in AMA, ISCA, SFM)
- ✓ Master of Commerce (M.Com), Rajasthan University – 2016 (50%)
- ✓ Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com), Rajasthan University – 2014 (61%)

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Employee of the Year:** Awarded at Cars24 in 2021 for exceptional performance and contributions.
- **Detail-Oriented Award:** Recognized as Detail-Oriented Awardee at Cars24 in 2022.
- **Performance Ratings:** Consistently received Outstanding/Excellent ratings across the 2021, 2022, 2023, 2025, and 2026 appraisal cycles.
- **GEM Award:** Awarded at Cargo Partner in 2024 and 2025.
- **Top Support Function Award:** Honored in the Process Category at Cargo Partner in 2024.

EXPERTISE

- **Strategic Finance & FP&A:** Financial Planning & Analysis, Budgeting & Forecasting, Variance Analysis Fundraising, Working Capital, KPI Dashboards, Business Partnering
- **Financial Controlling & Governance:** Ind-AS / IFRS, ICFR Framework, Financial Reporting, Consolidation, Cross Charge, Statutory & Tax Audit, ESOP Buyback, Internal Audit, GST Compliance, Transfer Pricing
- **Systems & Process Automation:** SAP S/4HANA, SAP B1, Cargowise Certified, Power BI, Tableau, Advanced Excel, Salesforce, Tally Prime, Artificial Intelligence